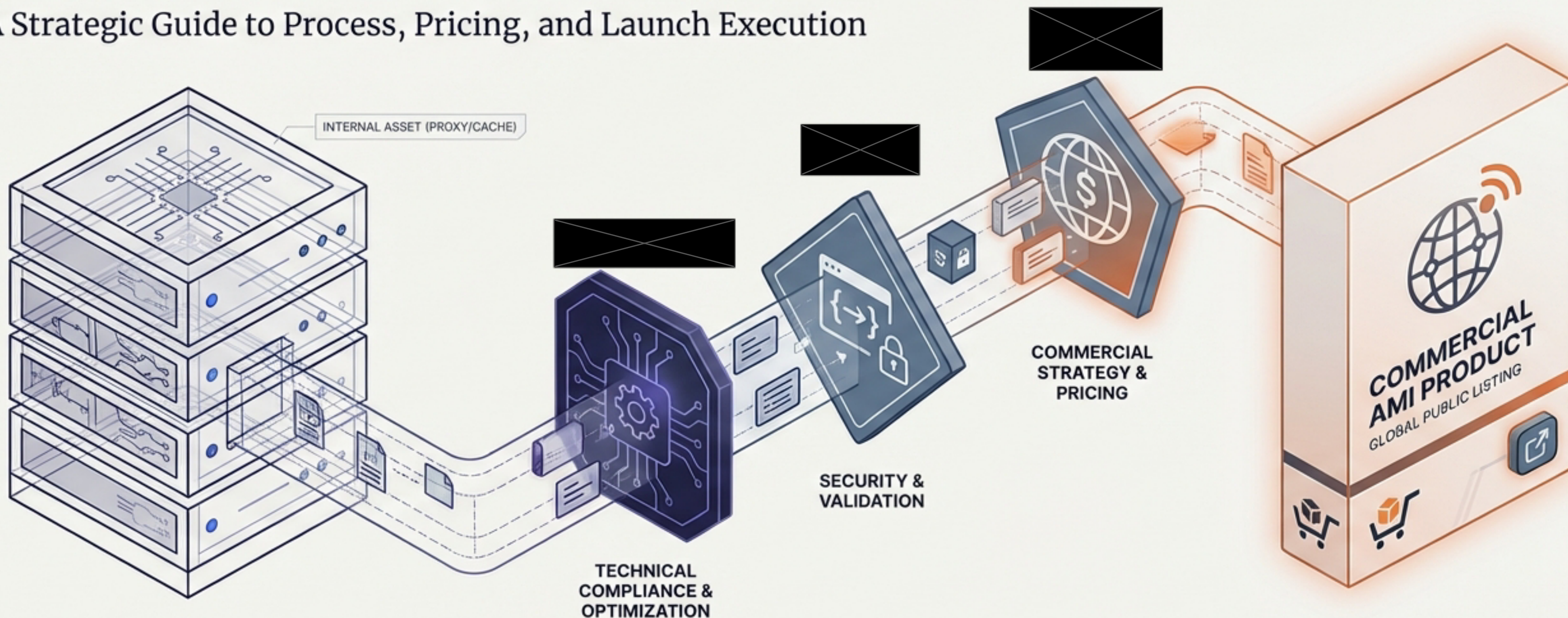


Publishing Commercial AMIs on AWS Marketplace

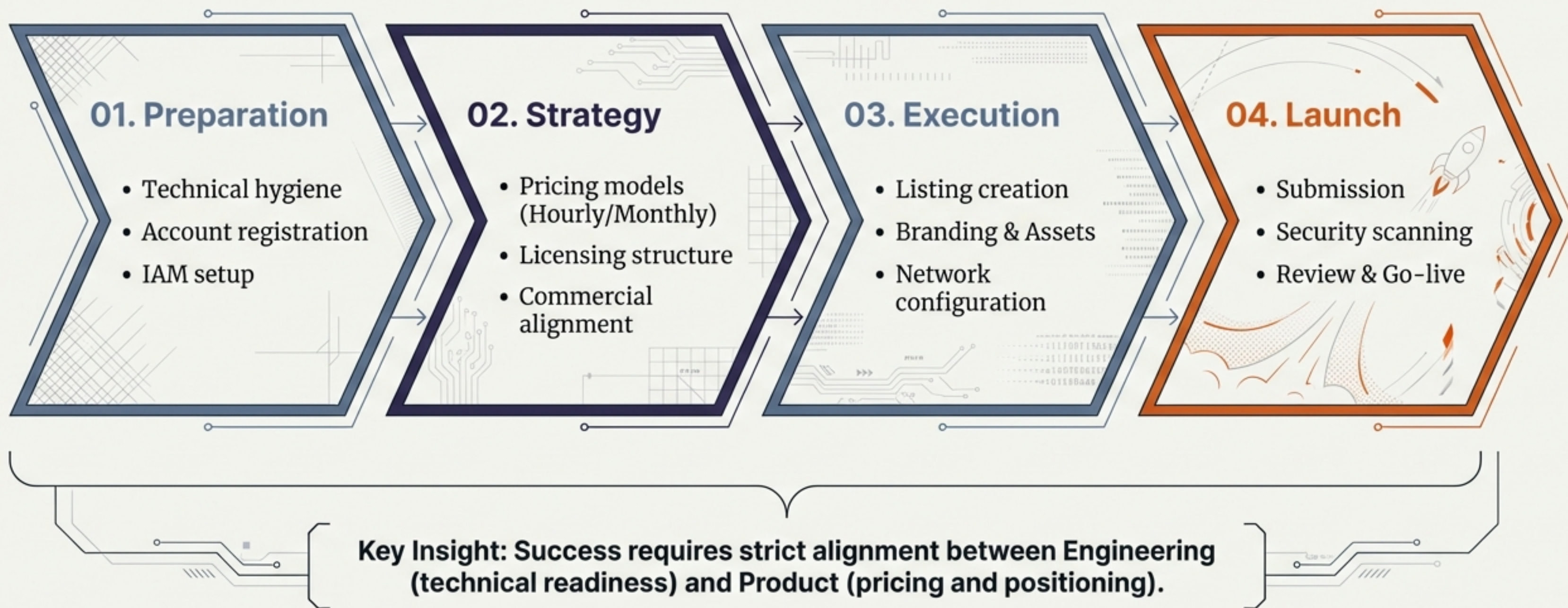
A Strategic Guide to Process, Pricing, and Launch Execution



SCOPE: END-TO-END JOURNEY // INTERNAL ASSET (PROXY/CACHE) -> PUBLIC LISTING // TECHNICAL COMPLIANCE + COMMERCIAL STRATEGY

From Internal Tool to Global Product

The four-phase journey to monetization.



Foundational Prerequisites and Account Setup



Seller Registration

- Must register as an AWS Marketplace seller.

Required Data:

- Business entity details
- Disbursement bank account
- Tax forms (W-9 for US / W-8 for non-US)



The Base Asset

- Region: Build in US East (N. Virginia / us-east-1 

Note: AWS uses **us-east-1** for ingestion; replicates globally later.
- OS: Supported versions only (Amazon Linux 2, Ubuntu, Windows Server 
).

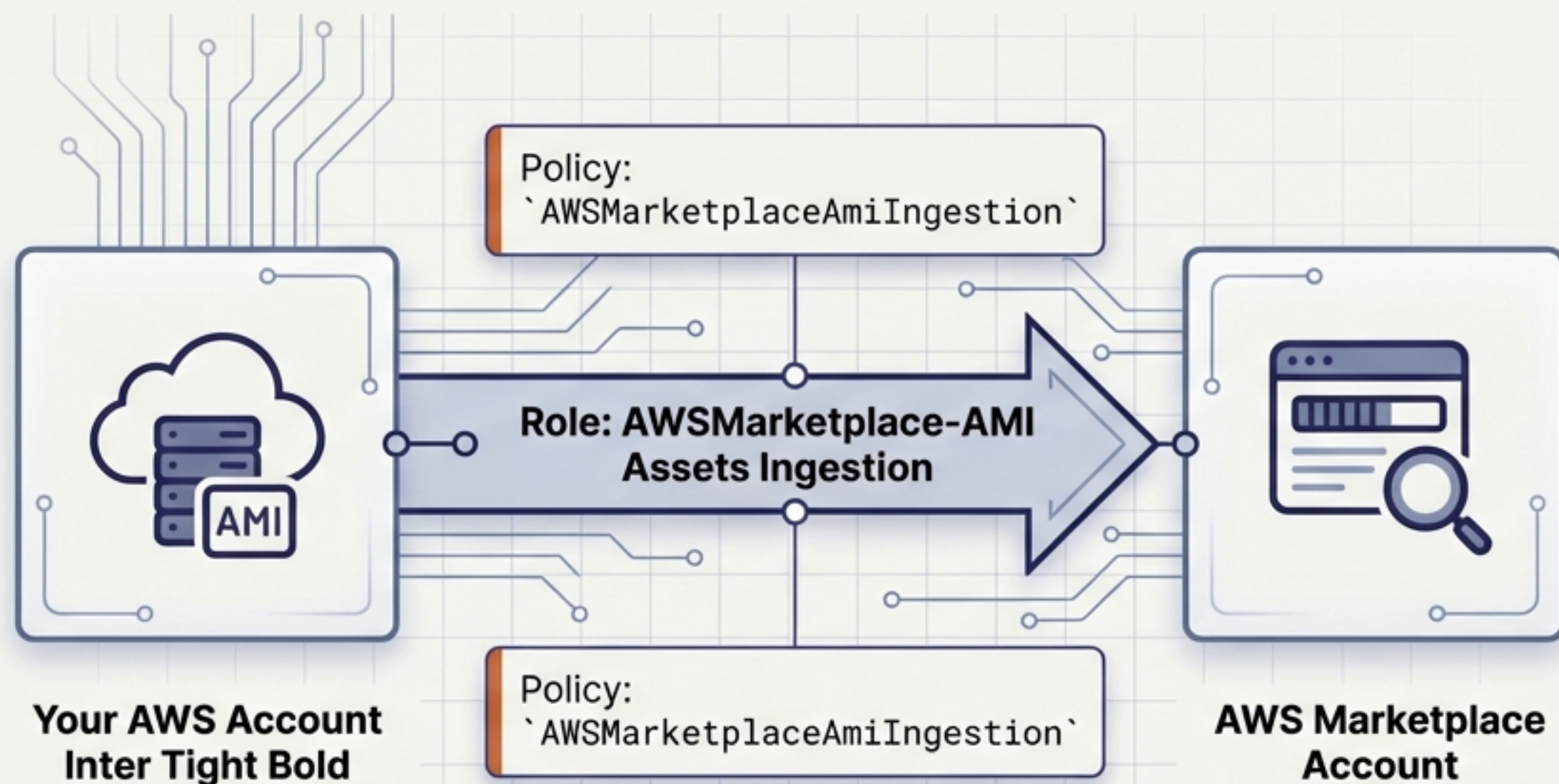


Access Control

- Sanitisation: No hardcoded credentials.
- Remove passwords, trial keys, or license files.
- Standard Login: Ensure standard user access.
 - e.g. ec2-user (Amazon Linux)
 - e.g. ubuntu (Ubuntu)

Ensure all points are verified before proceeding to the next phase.

Technical Hygiene and Security Compliance



Security Standards



- Patch all CVEs (Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures).



- Disable unnecessary ports.



- Open Source Rules:
 - **Must add value** (features/support).
 - **Transparent naming:** e.g. "Company X Proxy with Enhanced Support".
- Descriptions must state: "**charges apply**".

The Commercial Landscape: How Billing Works

AWS handles billing, collections, and currency conversion, remitting revenue (minus ~20% commission).

Model A: Free / Open Source



Model A: Free / Open Source Inter Tight Bold

Customer pays £0 for software.
Only pays for AWS infrastructure.
Unlimited instances.
Zero usage fees.

Model B: BYOL (Bring Your Own License)



Model B: BYOL (Bring Your Own License)

Listing appears as 'Free' in Marketplace.
Billing happens externally.
High Friction: Customer must contact vendor for a key.
AWS provides deployment vehicle only.

Model C: Paid (Integrated)



Model C: Paid (Integrated) Inter Tight Bold

Seamless addition to AWS bill.
Monetization via AWS.

Options:

- Hourly
- Monthly
- Annual
- Metered

Standard Pricing: Hourly and Annual Models

Hourly (Pay-As-You-Go)

- Mechanism: Metered per instance-hour.
- Rates vary by EC2 instance type (e.g., t3.medium vs c5.large).
- Best For: Transient workloads (e.g. Testing Proxy), variable demand.
- Incentive: Enable Free Trials (5-30 days) to encourage low-risk adoption.



Annual (Upfront Commitment)

- Mechanism: Lump sum payment for 12 months access.
- Specific to one instance type.
- Best For: Steady-state workloads (Production Infrastructure).
- Strategy: Combine Hourly + Annual.
- Offer ~30-40% savings on Annual to drive commitment.



Advanced Monetisation: Monthly, Metered, and Contracts

Monthly Subscription



Mechanism: Flat fee regardless of runtime hours.

SaaS-like predictability.

Best For: “**Always-on**” services (e.g., Caching Service) or per-seat licensing.

Usage-Based Metering



Mechanism: Charge per unit.

Units: Users, GB Data Processed, Bandwidth, Hosts.

Constraint: Requires **AWS Marketplace Metering SDK** integration to report usage hourly.

Private Offers



Mechanism: Negotiated custom terms.

Features: Multi-year contracts, volume discounts.

Visibility: Invisible to public; sent to specific AWS Account IDs.

High-touch enterprise sales channel.

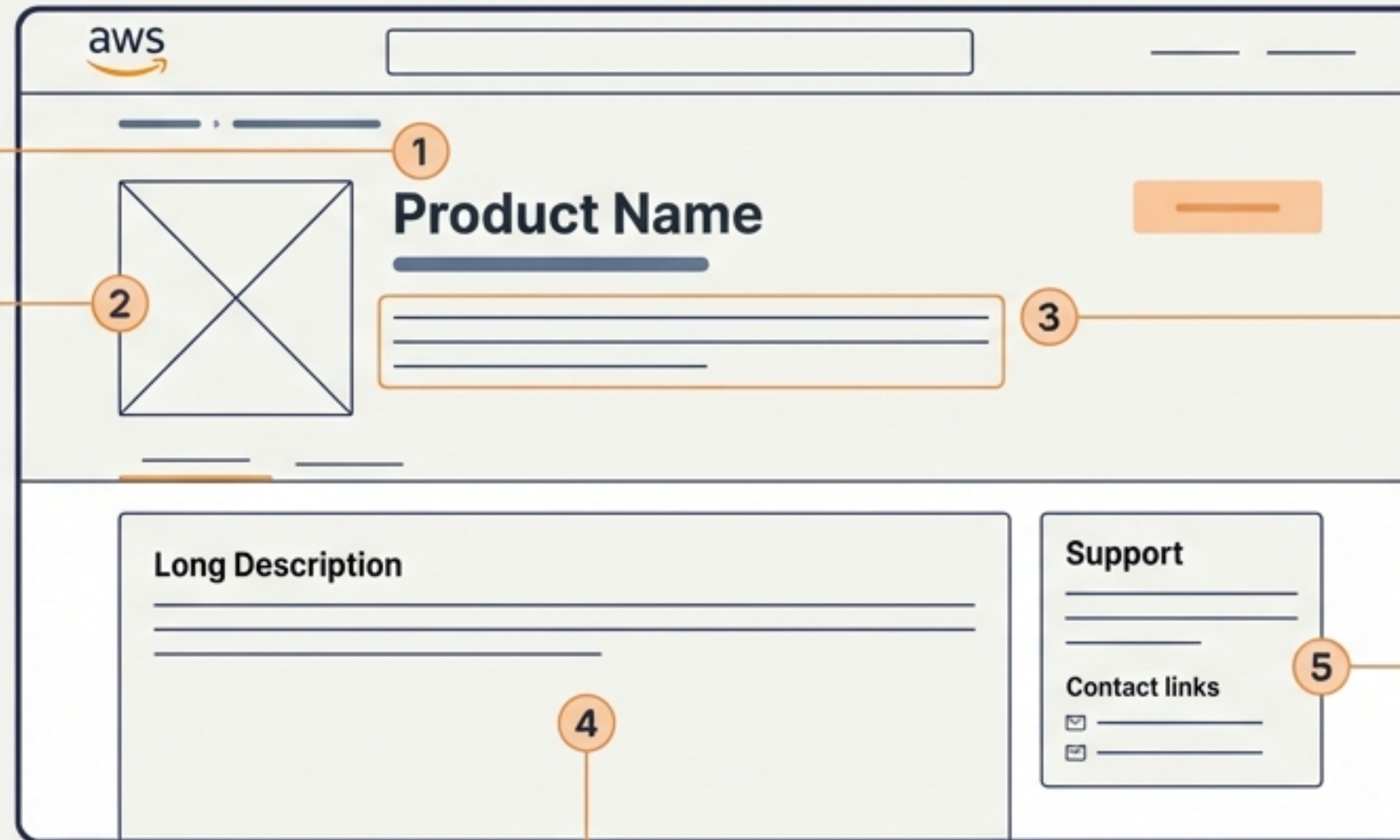
Creating the Listing: Branding and Value Proposition

1. Product Name

Clear value prop. Brand + Function (e.g., "Acme High-Speed Cache").

2. Visual Assets

1:1 or 2:1 ratio (120–640px).
Transparent PNG.



A diagram of the AWS Marketplace listing creation form. It features a header with the AWS logo and a search bar. The main form is divided into two sections. The top section contains a placeholder for a visual asset (a square with an 'X'), a text input field for the product name, and a short description text area. The bottom section contains a long description text area and a support section with contact links. Numbered callouts (1-5) point to specific fields: 1 points to the product name field, 2 points to the visual asset placeholder, 3 points to the short description text area, 4 points to the long description text area, and 5 points to the support section.

4. Long Description

Detailed features. Open-source disclosures must be the first paragraph.

3. Short Description

Search result hook (~200 chars). MUST disclose if charges apply.

5. Support

Define channels (Email, Portal, FAQ).

Network Configuration and Instance Architecture

Port Configuration

Purpose	Port(s)	Description
Standard	SSH (22) / RDP (3389)	For Admin Access
App Specific	e.g., 8080 (Proxy)	Traffic Interception
App Specific	e.g., 11211 (Memcached)	Caching Layer

Security Groups: Define default templates. Recommend restricted Source ranges (CIDR) rather than **0.0.0.0/0**.

Instance Support

Architecture: Define x86_64 vs ARM64.

Recommendations:

t3.medium (Lightweight / Dev)

c5.large (Compute Heavy / Prod)

m5.large (General Purpose)

The User Experience: Usage Instructions

Guiding the "Interested but Uninformed" user.

 DOCS

AWS Marketplace Listing Guide

Documentation View

Access

Run the following command to connect:

```
ssh -i key.pem ec2-user@<public-ip>
```

Initialisation

Access the Web UI at:

```
https://<public-ip>:8080
```

Default credentials are the Instance ID.

Dependencies

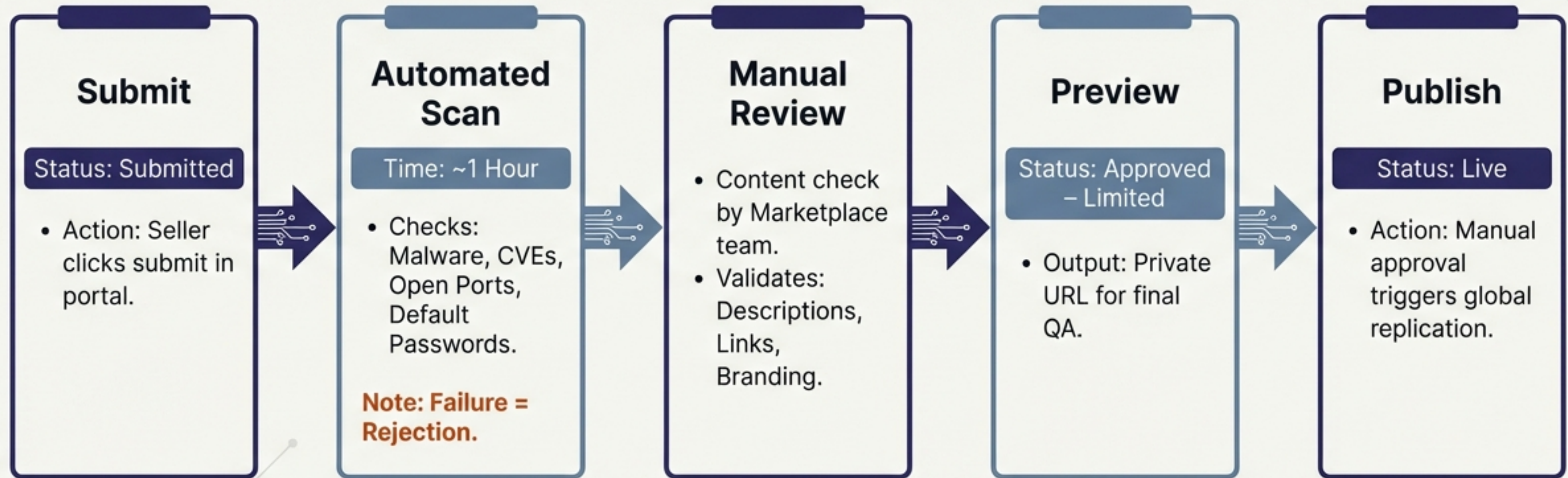
Crucial: Attach an IAM role with S3 write permissions to the instance. **Do not embed keys.**

External Links

[Download Full PDF Guide] ↗

[View API Documentation] ↗

The Review Pipeline: Submission to Publication



Use Case Spotlight: MITM Proxy Appliance

Category: Security / Developer Tools

Commercial Strategy

- **Recommended Pricing:** Hourly
- **Rationale:** Used for transient testing/QA tasks. Users spin up, test, and terminate.
- **Value Add:** Pre-configured API integrations & performance tuning (**differentiator** from open source).

Technical Specifics

- **Network:** Ensure TCP 8080 is open.
- **Documentation Criticality:** High.
- **Must explain:** Installing root certificates for HTTPS interception.
- **Must explain:** Accessing interception logs.

Use Case Spotlight: Caching Service

Category: Storage / Application Infrastructure

Commercial Strategy

- **Recommended Pricing:** **Monthly** or **Hourly + Annual**
- **Rationale:** Infrastructure runs continuously (24/7). Predictable billing is preferred.

Technical Specifics

- **Network:** Port 11211 (Memcached) or 6379 (Redis).
- **Security:** Restrict to **VPC CIDR**.
- **Infrastructure:** Advise on Provisioned IOPS or **High-Memory** instances.
- **Persistence:** Explain S3 backup configuration (IAM role attachment).

Post-Launch Management and Lifecycle

Versioning

Patching security issues = New Version.
Follow semantic versioning.

Lighter review process for updates.

Commercial Lock-in

Warning: Cannot switch from Free -> Paid easily.

Changing pricing models requires special approval.

Analytics

Monitor Dashboard:

Revenue

Downloads

Subscriber counts

Support Operations

Marketplace forwards inquiries to designated contact.

Maintain clear support channels.

Launch Readiness Checklist

☐	Account	☐ Seller registration complete. ☐ Tax/Bank info verified.
☐	Technical	☐ AMI built in <code>us-east-1</code>. ☐ Scanned for CVEs. Standard shell access confirmed (No hardcoded creds).
☐	Content	☐ Logo (PNG, correct ratio). ☐ EULA link active. Usage Instructions drafted (including dependencies).
☐	Pricing	☐ Model selected (Hourly vs. Monthly). ☐ Prices defined per instance type.
☐	Compliance	☐ Open source value-add explicitly stated in descriptions.

“Marketplace handles the infrastructure and billing; your focus remains on product quality and user support.”